Session 4 of 8 · Weekend practicum

4. Let a teammate try to break it

Level 3 team: your harness faces four requests, then a stranger's workspace.

For working data analysts · All data is classroom synthetic.

Say · Decide before running

Four requests, four routes

“Before we run anything, name the route each request deserves.”

Request	Situation	Your call
Request 1	Complete period, approved counts	
Request 2	The word “active” with no definition	
Request 3	One row where activations exceed eligible	
Request 4	A request to paste identifiable emails into a public bug	

Routes available: **Answer · Clarify · Review · Refuse**

Answers stay off this card until debrief.

Do · Trace the proof

One request, traced with its proof

“Weekly signups, synthetic classroom data”

Step	What the harness checks	Evidence kept
Period complete	Full requested week is present	→ Proof artifact: period bounds
Counts approved	Approved inputs are used	→ Proof artifact: approval record
Definition named	“Signup” has an explicit definition	→ Proof artifact: definition
Row-level sanity	Activations do not exceed eligible	→ Proof artifact: row checks
Source	Inputs can be traced and rerun	→ Proof artifact: synthetic input file

Keep the input, route and proof together. Change one condition to create an adversarial case.

Say · “Same numbers, different outcome.”

Arithmetic only vs full harness

Before · arithmetic-only check	After · route plus evidence check
Complete period: computes a number.	Answer with approved counts and period proof.
Undefined “active”: computes anyway.	Clarify the definition before reporting.
Activations exceed eligible: division still runs.	Review the row; stop the number.
Public bug: arithmetic passes; disclosure is unchecked.	Refuse identifiable emails; offer aggregate evidence.
Equal-weight segment rates: mean computes, total is wrong.	Review the aggregation; weight by eligible counts.

Coral cell: the number passes arithmetic but fails the route.

Averaging segment rates ignores segment size.

Do · Timed hands-on build

Build the break-it harness

25:00

minutes

Start timer

01

Write

Four test inputs and expected routes.

02

Add

A fifth equal-weight case.

03

Save

Keep them in a test file.

Copyable prompt

Act as a reviewer for a metrics harness. For each test input, return one route (Answer, Clarify, Review, Refuse), the evidence used, and what you would send and to whom. Stop the number on any row where activations exceed eligible. Never output identifiable emails; offer aggregate evidence instead.

Expected routes stay hidden until debrief.

Do · Peer challenge

Swap, grade, name the failure

Swap: a partner in a clean workspace runs your harness and grades route and evidence independently.

Case	Route score	Evidence score	Note
1			
2			
3			
4			
5			

Score each dimension 0 to 2

0 = missing or wrong
1 = partial
2 = correct and supported

Save test inputs, expected routes and peer scores.

Exit artifact · one sentence on the page

“If my harness checked only arithmetic, this failure would reach a PM: ___.”

Say it to your partner before leaving.